

Step-By-Step College Guide

Graduate College with a Bachelor's Degree
in Under 2 Years
and save 50% on your degree



Fastrack

Introduction

Hello, Andrew here, founder of Fastrack. I want to personally thank you for purchasing the guide! You're on the path to achieve incredible success by completing your bachelor's degree in 2 years, all while saving tens of thousands of dollars. I did it, and in this guide, I will be explaining how you or your child can do the same. Let's start with a brief description of my path.

I started taking college-level courses as a high school sophomore. By the time I graduated from high school, I had completed 42 college credits through dual-credit courses, amounting to over 3 semesters of college. The best part? These credits cost just a fraction of traditional on-campus college courses - 10-15x cheaper, or \$25/per credit instead of \$300.

After high school, I enrolled in a university that accepted transfer credits where I took an extra course each semester, and was able to complete 20 credits per semester, further accelerating my progress. I also completed a full semester's worth of online college courses during the summer of my freshman year. I then finished my last semester online, while traveling the world and running my business.

The result? I graduated with my bachelor's degree in just two years, saving around \$50,000 and setting myself up for future success. It's shocking how few students, parents, and guidance counselors are even aware of these opportunities.

With the time and money I saved, I was able to start a project management company, travel the world, focus on my hobbies, and make business connections and friends along the way.

Now, I want to help others achieve the same success, with tips and insights outside the scope provided by traditional and antiquated guidance counselors. That's why I've created this comprehensive guide to help you or your child graduate in just 2 years or less. I've also uncovered additional strategies - beyond my own experiences - to speed up the process even further, as well as a broader framework that can be customized to suit any ambitious students' needs.

Continue reading to discover the secrets to graduating college faster, and jumpstarting your future success.

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College Credit Opportunities for High School Students

Taking advantage of college credit opportunities during high school can significantly affect how long it takes to earn your degree and can save you tons of money. In this section, we will explore various options to earn college credits while still in high school.

Sources Of College Credits During High School

Dual Credit Programs:

Dual credit programs allow high school students to enroll in college level courses that count towards both their high school diploma and college degree. These are the classes that we recommend taking the most of, because of their availability, transferability, and cost effectiveness.

International Baccalaureate (IB) Programs:

The IB program is another avenue for earning college credits during high school. Universities around the world recognize the IB diploma and in certain cases grant preferential entry and college credit. The IB programs are generally more rigorous, and are something that if you are not already familiar with, are probably not the most efficient use of your time.

Advanced Placement (AP) Classes:

Another option for earning college credits in high school is by taking AP courses and scoring well on the corresponding AP exams. These courses are more rigorous than typical high school classes, but they count for both high school and college-level credits if you perform well on the exams.

College Level Examination Program (CLEP) Tests:

CLEP tests offer another opportunity to earn college credits while in high school. These tests measure proficiency in various subjects, and will allow you to bypass taking college courses, while still earning the credits.

Most important tips when considering enrollment in Dual Credit Courses, IB, AP, and CLEP

Start Early and Enroll in Multiple Courses:

The earlier you begin taking dual credit courses, the more time and money you can save. While I started by taking one course at the end of my sophomore year without any extra tests, I wish I had started earlier or enrolled in more courses.

Learn from My Experience:

One of the mistakes I made was not starting dual credit courses as early as possible. If you begin taking these courses earlier in high school, you can maximize the number of college credits you earn before graduating high school. This not only saves you time but also significantly reduces your college expenses. Proper planning makes a big difference here.

In summary:

There are various options for taking advantage of earning college credits in high school that can significantly impact your college journey. Our #1 recommendation is prioritizing dual credit classes. By starting early, enrolling in multiple courses, and exploring different credit earning options, you can save time and money while earning a bachelor's degree in under 2 years.

Understanding Transferring College Credits

Transferring credits between institutions is an essential aspect of accelerating your college education. In this section, we will discuss choosing a college with an easy transfer credit process, the process of transferring credits, and how to maximize your credit transfers. Researching and understanding this aspect is an essential part of the college planning process. You need to verify that the schools your child is considering attending accept the credits from the dual credits, AP, or CLEP programs they will be partaking in, or else those credits will not count.

Understand Transfer Policies:

Each college or university has its own policies for accepting transfer credits. Familiarize yourself with the transfer policies of your child's target institutions, including which courses are accepted, the minimum grade required for transfer credit acceptance, and any limitations on the number of transfer credits allowed. You'll want to choose a university that accepts a high amount of transfer credits. Almost all universities accept a minimum of 30 credits (1 year) and the majority accept 60 credits (2 years). Some schools accept 90 transfer credits (3 years)

Ask your target institution about their policies:

Speak with academic advisors at your target institution to understand the transfer process and ensure that you are on track to meet your academic goals. Advisors can help you select courses that will transfer successfully and guide you through the transfer process.

Maintain Detailed Records:

Keep detailed records of your completed coursework, including course names, what institution they were completed at, what credits they counted for, final grades received, and official transcripts. These records can be helpful for managing what courses you have already completed when submitting this information to colleges, as well as for creating a comprehensive graduation plan.

Submit Required Documentation:

Ensure that you submit all required documentation, such as official transcripts and course descriptions to your target institution in a timely manner. Incomplete or late submissions can result in the denial of credit transfers.

Understanding Transferring College Credits

Verify Transfer of Credits:

Once you have submitted your documentation and completed the transfer process, verify that your credits have been accurately transferred to your target institution. Review your academic records and consult with your academic advisor at your university to ensure that everything is in order.

In summary:

By understanding the transfer process, researching your desired schools policies on where they accept transfer credits from, and working closely with academic advisors from your desired college, you can maximize your credit transfers and accelerate your college education. Staying organized and informed will help you navigate the transfer process smoothly and ensure you successfully reach your academic goals.

Further Schedule Enhancements During College

In this section, we will discuss accelerated degree programs and online courses, which can help you further reduce the time it takes to earn your bachelor's degree. By taking advantage of these opportunities, you can complete your degree faster and more efficiently.

Online College Courses

Online courses offer flexibility and convenience, making them an attractive option for students looking to expedite their college education. Many accredited colleges and universities provide online courses that can be taken alongside your regular coursework or during summer and winter breaks. (From my experience, these online courses are often less time-intensive, while still providing a thorough education)

Advantages of Online Courses:

In addition to their flexibility and convenience, online courses can also save you money. Online tuition fees are often lower than on-campus fees, and you can save on expenses related to transportation and housing. Additionally, online courses may provide access to unique classes or programs not available at your primary institution.

Accelerated Degree Programs:

Many colleges and universities offer accelerated degree programs that enable students to complete their bachelor's degree in a shorter time frame than traditional programs. These programs often combine undergraduate and graduate coursework, allowing students to earn their degree at an accelerated pace. Research institutions that offer accelerated programs in your field of interest and inquire about their admission requirements and course schedules

In summary:

By exploring accelerated degree programs and online courses, you can significantly reduce the time it takes to earn your bachelor's degree. These opportunities allow you to customize your college experience, save money, and reach your academic goals more quickly. Perhaps most importantly, enrolling in an online program gives you extra freedom to explore what interests you, whenever you want - from developing your resume with work experience or even enjoying the college experience at your own pace.

Utilizing Summer Breaks

Summer breaks during college can be a great time to accelerate your progress toward earning a bachelor's degree. In this section, we will discuss how to make the most of your summer breaks by enrolling in summer classes, taking online courses, and exploring other educational opportunities.

Enroll In Summer Courses:

Many colleges and universities offer summer courses, which can be taken on-campus or online. These courses typically cover the same material as their semester counterparts but are condensed into a shorter time frame. By enrolling in summer courses, you can accumulate more credits and reduce your time to graduation.

Online Summer Courses:

If you prefer the flexibility and convenience of online learning, search for online summer courses offered by accredited institutions. As with any online course, ensure that the credits can be transferred to your primary institution and count towards your degree requirements.

Internships and Co-op Programs:

Summer breaks can also be a great time to gain practical experience in your field through internships and co-op programs. While these opportunities may contribute to your college credits, that's not the only benefit; they can also enhance your resume, develop your professional skills, and help you establish connections in your industry.

Study Abroad Programs:

Summer study abroad programs allow you to explore new cultures while earning college credits. These programs typically last a few weeks to a couple of months and can provide a unique and enriching educational experience while helping you stack more credits.

Plan Ahead for Summer Scheduling:

To make the most of your summer breaks, start planning early. Research summer course offerings, internships, research opportunities, and study abroad programs well in advance to secure your spot and ensure a productive summer. By maximizing your summer breaks and taking advantage of the educational opportunities available, you can significantly reduce the time it takes to earn your bachelor's degree.

Financial Aid, Grants And Scholarships

Accelerating your college path already drastically reduces the costs associated with colleges, but with the right resources and strategies, it is possible to reduce costs even further. In this section, we will explore financial aid options, grants, and scholarships specifically designed for students in accelerated programs.

Federal Financial Aid:

These are loans, not free money, however they are interest free options up to a certain level based on income. To see your offer, complete the Free Application for Federal Student Aid (FAFSA) to determine your eligibility for federal financial aid. Be sure to submit your FAFSA as early as possible, as some funds are distributed on a first-come, first-served basis

Institutional Financial Aid:

Many colleges and universities offer financial aid packages to students in accelerated programs. Contact your target institution's financial aid office to inquire about available funding and application procedures.

State Grants and Scholarships:

Research state-sponsored grants and scholarships, which may be available to residents pursuing accelerated degree programs. These opportunities can vary by state, so visit your state's higher education agency website for more information.

Merit-Based Scholarships:

Many scholarships are awarded based on SAT/ACT scores, GPA, academic achievement, leadership, and community involvement. You can apply for local, university, or national merit-based scholarships to help fund your accelerated education. Universities often have merit based scholarships that are automatically applied.

Need-Based Grants and Scholarships:

If you have financial need, research grants and scholarships that take financial need into consideration. These awards can help reduce the burden of college expenses for low income families.

Private Scholarships:

Explore private scholarships from foundations, corporations, and community organizations. These scholarships often have specific eligibility criteria, such as essays, volunteer work, etc, so be sure to research the qualifications for each opportunity carefully.

In summary:

By researching and applying for financial aid, grants, and scholarships, you can reduce the financial burden of your accelerated college education. With careful planning and dedication, you can fund your education and achieve your academic goals in a shorter time frame (Your HS academic counselor is your best resource here, don't be afraid to use them! It's their job, but in our experience, they often need to be directed away from the path of least resistance.)

Advanced Schedule Management Strategies

Successfully accelerating your college education while maintaining a healthy lifestyle requires effective time management strategies, burnout prevention, and striking the right balance between academics, work, and social life. In this section, we will discuss techniques that can help you achieve this balance and enjoy a well-rounded college experience.

Prioritize Your Commitments:

Assess your academic, work, and social commitments and prioritize them based on their importance. Allocate more time and energy to high-priority tasks.

Create a Comprehensive Schedule:

Develop a schedule that outlines when and where you will work on each class, as well as time for work, hobbies, and social activities. Be realistic and flexible, as you may need to adjust your schedule to accommodate unexpected events or changing priorities.

Break Tasks into Smaller Chunks:

Divide large tasks into smaller, more manageable steps to make them feel less overwhelming. Set small, achievable goals for each study session to maintain motivation and track your progress.

Practice Effective Time Management:

Set aside specific times for studying, relaxing, and engaging in hobbies. Factor in time for self-exercise, and social activities to maintain balance.

Conclusion

Thank you for reading this guide, I hope it helps you or your child along your/ their academic journey. The step-by-step actionable checklist is on the next page.

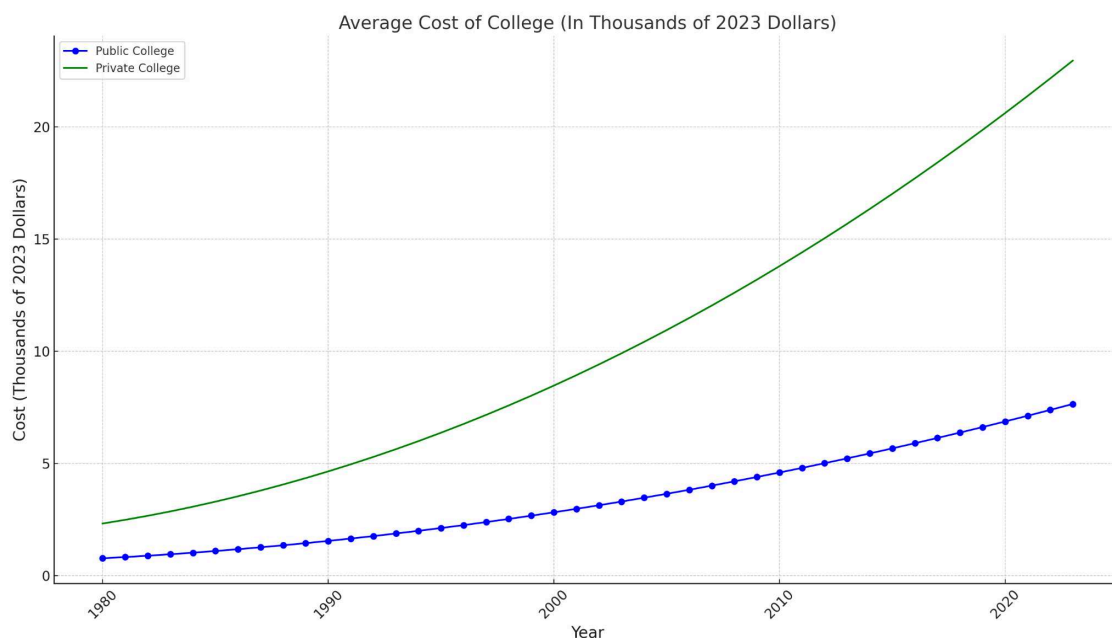
Throughout this guide, we have explored various strategies and techniques to help you or your child graduate with a bachelor's degree in under two years, saving tens of thousands of dollars in the process.

Remember that proper planning, research, and organization are essential components of successfully navigating this accelerated journey. Regularly assess your situation and seek guidance when necessary. By following this approach, you will not only save valuable time and money but also gain the freedom to pursue your passions and achieve your goals beyond the classroom.

Now that you have the knowledge and tools, it's time to take the first step. By following the step-by-step instructions on the next page, You can create your optimized schedule so that you or your child can graduate in just two years, saving tens of thousands of dollars and setting yourself or your child up for future success.

In hindsight, had I known about some of the resources I shared with you in this guide, I could have graduated in just one year instead of two. Whether your goal is simply to get your degree as fast as possible from home, or if you are looking to attend university in person for the college experience (what I did) but still want to graduate early and save money, taking dual credit courses will be extremely beneficial.

It is unbelievable how much the cost of a college degree has increased in recent years. My goal for this guide was to provide a low cost summary of the information that took me years to acquire and saved me over \$50,000. I hope you found value in this information.



Actionable Step List

Step 1: Research Dual Credit and AP Programs and CLEP tests:

Action item 1 :

Search for "high school/college dual credit programs near me.", "AP course at <CURRENT HIGH SCHOOL>", "CLEP tests in <YOUR STATE>".

Step 2: Research Transfer credit policies for your dual credit or AP classes and desired colleges:

Action item 2 :

Search "<YOUR DESIRED COLLEGE> incoming transfer credit policies"
If you can't find clear information regarding your specific situation, proceed to step 3.

Step 3: Contact your target institution:

Action item 3 :

Search "<YOUR DESIRED COLLEGE> incoming academic schedule advisors".
Find phone numbers and emails and either call or email the advisors at the institution.
Tell them which dual credit or AP classes or CLEP tests you are planning on taking and ask them to verify if those credits will transfer to their institution and if there are any stipulations.

Step 4: Put together a spreadsheet consisting of the dual credit , AP, and CLEP opportunities available to you:

Action item 4 :

create a google spreadsheet and fill in potential dual credit and AP courses and CLEP tests that are available in your area.

Actionable Step List

Step 5: Put Together A Spreadsheet That Combines Your Current High School Schedule With The Dual Credit, AP, and CLEP Opportunities That Are Available:

Action item 5:

Create a google spreadsheet and fill in your high school schedule along with potential dual credit and AP courses and CLEP tests that are available in your area. Make sure you account for your high school course requirements, that can be found by searching “<YOUR HIGH SCHOOL> coursework graduation requirements” This will lead you to a student handbook in most cases that will tell you the exact number of classes or credits you need in each subject to get your high school diploma. You can use this information to determine which dual credit classes will count for both your high school and college requirements. For example, if you need to take 3 Social Science classes to graduate high school, and one of them is Psychology, and you also need to take a Psychology class as a general education requirement for your desired college degree, you could take a Psychology class as a dual credit at a local community college to fulfill both your high school requirement and your college requirement.

Step 6: Research local scholarship opportunities:

Action item 6:

Search “Scholarships for <YOUR HIGH SCHOOL> Students”.

Step 7: Research Scholarships opportunities at your desired universities:

Action item 7:

Search “Merit based scholarships at <YOUR DESIRED UNIVERSITY>” and “public and private scholarships and grants at <YOUR DESIRED UNIVERSITY>”.

Step 8: Put together all of the information you have gathered in one centralized and organized location:

Action item 8:

Create a google drive called something like “My College Plan.” Put all of the google sheets you created in this drive, along with any research you have done and condensed into google documents, any correspondence with high school or college academic advisors, and any scholarship information you have found. Having all of this information in one place that is easily accessible will help you drastically when planning, and will also help greatly when you are applying to universities and need to cross reference information.

Next Steps

Do it yourself

Everything you need is in this guide. Work through the checklist, confirm each course against your target college, and build the schedule one term at a time.

Run your numbers, free

See what a degree really costs at more than 6,000 colleges, with real federal net-price data, and what finishing credits in high school saves your family:

fastrack.school/calculator

Or have us build the whole plan

The Fastrack Credit Map is a done-for-you, term-by-term course plan checked against the actual transfer rules of your target college. Real course codes, a source for every verified line, delivered within 7 business days. \$497, with a 30-day no-questions refund:

fastrack.school/credit-map

Questions? Reply to any of our emails or write to info@fastrack.school.